**Achievement EHCP TARGET progression mapping**

**Cardinality Strand Overview**

The cardinality strand focuses on developing pupils' understanding that numbers represent quantity. It moves from early awareness that amounts can change, through to recognising that counting answers the question "how many," and then towards understanding that quantity remains the same despite changes in appearance. At its highest level, pupils develop the ability to recognise quantities instantly without counting. This strand is essential in helping pupils move from performing counting procedures to understanding what numbers actually mean.

**Why is it important?**

Cardinality is what turns counting into understanding. It underpins calculating accurately, selecting correct quantities, and understanding number in context.

Without this - pupils can count but don't understand quantity so calculation becomes procedural and fragile

With it - number becomes meaningful and learning transfers across contexts

**Pathway Aim**

By the end of the pathway, pupils will be able to understand that numbers represent quantity, determine how many are in a set, and recognise quantities in a range of ways, including without counting**.**

**Example Evidence Statements**

"The pupil can count a group of objects and state how many there are."
"They recognise that rearranging objects does not change the total."
"They can identify quantities up to 5 instantly without counting."

| **Quantity Awareness** ***(Bands 1–3)*** | **Counting Has Meaning** ***(Bands 4–5)*** | **Conservation & Reasoning** ***(Bands 5–6)*** | **Subitising** ***(Band 7)*** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pupils develop an awareness that quantities can change through adding or removing objects. They respond to changes in amount but are not yet linking counting to quantity. | Pupils begin to understand that counting tells us "how many." They recognise that the final number in a count represents the total quantity. | Pupils understand that quantity remains the same even when objects are rearranged and begin to explain how they know. | Pupils recognise small quantities instantly without counting and identify amounts in familiar arrangements. |

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| **Key stage Target**<br>By the end of the key stage, the pupil will show understanding that quantities can change through adding or removing objects and will respond appropriately in practical situations. | **Key stage Target**<br>By the end of the key stage, the pupil will understand that the final number in a count represents the total quantity and will use this to answer "how many" questions. | **Key stage Target**<br>By the end of the key stage, the pupil will understand that quantity remains the same when objects are rearranged and will begin to explain how they know. | **Key stage Target**<br>By the end of the key stage, the pupil will recognise and identify small quantities instantly without counting in familiar arrangements. |
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| **Typical evidence might include:**<br>• reacting when objects are added or removed<br>• anticipating more<br>• different responses to one vs many | **Typical evidence might include:**<br>• answering "how many?" after counting<br>• selecting a given number of objects<br>• matching numerals to quantities | **Typical evidence might include:**<br>• recognising quantity is unchanged when rearranged<br>• explaining thinking (verbally or through gesture)<br>• recounting to check | **Typical evidence might include:**<br>• recognising small quantities instantly<br>• identifying familiar patterns (e.g. dice, dots)<br>• responding quickly without counting |
| **Mapped curriculum targets**<br>**Band 1**<br>• I can react to changes in amount when they are significant<br>• I can notice when something has been added or taken away<br>• I can demonstrate awareness of "more" through looking, reaching or vocalising<br>**Band 2**<br>• I can respond to words like more<br>• I can anticipate when more items are added<br>• I can respond differently to one object and many objects<br>**Band 3**<br>• I can notice when a group becomes bigger or smaller | **Mapped curriculum targets**<br>**Band 4**<br>• I can take or give two or three objects<br>• I can notice numerals<br>• I can count using objects or fingers<br>• I can say how many after counting with support<br>**Band 5**<br>• I can understand the last number tells how many<br>• I can match numerals to quantities up to 5<br>• I can represent numbers using objects or marks<br>• I can recount to check<br>• I can select a number of objects when asked (up to 5) | **Mapped curriculum targets**<br>**Band 5**<br>• I can recount to check<br>**Band 6**<br>• I can count out up to 10 objects<br>• I can match numerals to quantities<br>• I can understand rearranging does not change total<br>• I can explain how I know how many | **Mapped curriculum targets**<br>**Band 7**<br>• I can subitise up to 5<br>• I can recognise quantities without counting<br>• I can subitise familiar arrangements quickly |

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| • I can combine small groups and notice there are more<br>• I can sometimes give one or two objects when asked | | | |
| **Next Step:** understand that counting tells how many | **Next Step:** *understand that quantity remains the same despite changes* | **Next Step:** *recognise quantities instantly without counting* | **Next Step:** Apply instant recognition of quantity to support efficient calculation and early number facts (e.g. number bonds, addition within 10) |